

# KILL YOUR DARLINGS

## CURATE YOUR IMAGES / WEEK 3

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General AI Fluency · Ateeq Ur Rehman

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Portfolio Direction: AI Engineering, Backend Systems, AI Automation, APIs, and Production-Oriented Projects

### 01 IMAGE MAP — WHAT THE PORTFOLIO ACTUALLY NEEDS

- PERSON / ABOUT** Real personal photo — authentic representation of the developer.
- PROJECTS** Real screenshots of applications, dashboards, APIs and technical work.
- ARCHITECTURE** Real diagrams or clean technical visuals that explain system structure.
- HERO / CONNECTIVE TISSUE** One restrained AI-generated technical texture; optional, not evidence.

### 02 KEEPERS — REAL WORK FIRST

- ✓ Project UI screenshot — actual build
- ✓ API / endpoint screenshot — actual implementation
- ✓ Architecture or workflow diagram — actual system
- ✓ GitHub / repository visual — actual project
- ✓ Real personal photo — for About section

### 03 AI KEEPER — CONNECTIVE TISSUE

#### Minimal technical hero texture

Dark neutral field with a subtle abstract AI/backend pipeline, thin interface-like lines, restrained blue and teal accents, generous negative space. No robot, brain, hologram or fake dashboard.

Purpose: atmosphere only, never proof.

### 04 REJECTED IMAGE — DISCERNMENT NOTE

#### Rejected: “Futuristic AI brain surrounded by glowing circuits”

I rejected this because it communicates “AI” in a generic way but does not communicate what I actually build. The metaphor is visually loud, widely used, and can compete with the engineering evidence. A restrained technical texture is more consistent with the identity kit and leaves the real project screenshots as the strongest proof.

### 05 REAL CAPTURE OVER AI — FINAL DECISION

**DECISION** For every project case study, I choose the real capture first: the actual interface, API response, architecture, database view, repository, or deployed result.

**AI USE** AI-generated visuals are limited to connective tissue or conceptual explanation when a real capture cannot communicate the idea clearly.

Rule: generated visuals support the portfolio; they do not impersonate evidence of functionality.